connection to the server, we create a new instance of the PDO PHP class and pass it some arguments. The first is a connection DSN (Data Source Name), then the account name followed by the password. The DSN will vary depending on how you are running PHP.

If it is installed as a package on your system:

```
$pdo = new PDO(
    'mysql:host=127.0.0.1;port=3306;dbname=testdb',
    'root',
    'root123'
);
```

If you are running PHP inside a container, you'll need to make sure you can connect to the `maridb` container on the local loopback address `127.0.0.1` by ensuring the PHP container is using the host network. Here's a reminder of the Docker command alias from earlier in the chapter:

```
$ alias docker-php='docker run -it --rm --net=host -p 8000:8000 -v "$PWD":
/usr/src/myapp -w /usr/src/myapp php:8.4-cli php'
```

In either case, the PHP code above is creating an instance of a PDO object; the strings in the parentheses are the constructor arguments (data that is used to build the object), and all of this is covered in Chapter 3, "Functions" (where function arguments and parameters are explained), and Chapter 6, "Object Fundamentals" (which explains how objects and classes work). For now, you just need to know that the first argument – `'mysql:host=127.0.0.1;port=3306;dbname=testdb'` – is the connection DSN (Data Source Name), which breaks down into sections like so:

Table 1-11. *DSN components*

`mysql:`	The "driver" required – this tells PDO that we're communicating with a server that "speaks"MySQL
`host=...`	Where to contact the server, which can be an IP address, hostname, etc.
`port=...`	The TCP port on which the server is listening (MySQL defaults to TCP 3306)
`dbname=...`	The database we wish to use